Students Activity

State any one drug that you are commonly using in your home for minor ailments and describe about its action and side effects.

Proven Human Teratogens:

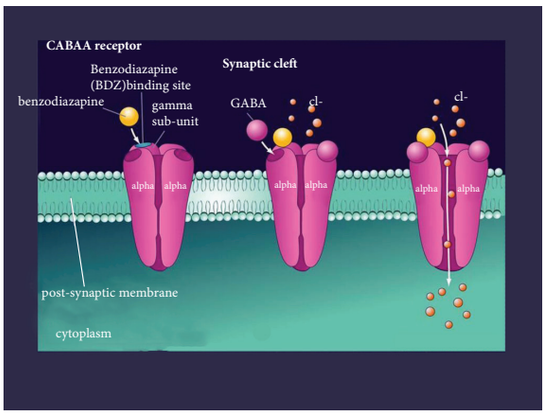
Drug	Abnormality
Thalidomide	Phocomelia, multiple defects
Anti-neoplastic drugs	Multiple defects, foetal death
Androgens	Virilization, esophageal, cardiac defects
Progestins	Virilization of female foetus
Stilboestrol	Vaginal carcinoma
Tetracyclines	Discloured teeth, bone defects
Warfarin	Nose, Eye, Hand defects, Growth retardation
Phenytoin	Cleft lip/palate, microcephaly, hypoplastic phalanges



Teratogenic drugs:

A teratogen is an agent that can disturb the development of the embryo or fetus. This produce a congenital malformation (a birth defect) ex., radiation exposure, drugs used for maternal infection.

11.12 Mechanism of Drug Action



Two types of mechanisms

1. Non-receptor mediated
2. Receptor mediated

Non-receptor mediated mechanisms include:

1. By physical action like osmosis, absorption.
2. By chemical action like antacids, metals.
3. Through enzymes like angiotensin converting enzyme inhibitor.
4. Through antibody production like vaccines.
5. Placebo which is a dummy medicine having no pharmacological activity like distilled water.

Receptor mediated mechanisms include:

1. Affinity: Ability of the drug to get bound to the receptor.
2. Agonist: Capable of producing pharmacological action after binding to the receptor.

Nursing-Gen_Chapter 11.indd 218 07/05/18 1:48 PM